

The Tall Grass Near Branford*

by

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SATURDAY

Opening TITLE SEQUENCE

1. EXT. WINDY SEASIDE ROAD - DAY

DALLAS (40s) and his son MAC (10) drive along a winding seaside road. The rugged coastline stretches beside them, with Atlantic waves crashing against the rocks. A storm brews in the distance, dark clouds gathering on the horizon.

2. EXT. NEW HOUSE - SOUTHERN CONNECTICUT COAST - DAY

Dallas signs papers on a clipboard handed to him by a MOVER. The Movers begin unloading boxes from the truck.

Nearby, a TV CAMERAMAN and a CAMERA CREW capture a REPORTER speaking into the camera. Mac watches from a distance, curious and uncertain about the commotion.

3. EXT. NEW HOUSE - DRIVEWAY - DAY

Dallas and Mac unload various items from a bucket in the back of their sedan. Among the items are an unfinished bird feeder and gardening tools.

Dallas pauses, staring somberly at the bucket. His emotions overwhelm for a moment.

Mac notices his father's hesitation and gently takes over, finishing the task without a word.

4. INT. NEW HOUSE - MAC'S ROOM - DUSK

Mac stands by the window, gazing out at the dimming light. Fireflies flicker in the tall grass. As the wind sways the branches, the fireflies' lights resemble the glint of eyes peering from the darkness.

Mac looks around the skies - clear.

5. INT. KITCHEN - NIGHT

Dallas carefully plates an avocado, an onion, and a sliced lemon--meticulously into small pieces and then reassembled to appear untouched. His movements are deliberate, almost ritualistic.

Mac sets the table and turns on the TV. He flips through channels until he finds the local weather report.

ON TV: The same REPORTER from earlier, standing outside their house, discusses the unpredictable weather this time of year.

Thunder rumbles in the distance, adding to the tension as the storm approaches.

FADE OUT.

Sunday

1. INT. CHURCH - MORNING

The PASTOR stands at the pulpit, addressing the congregation. The church is filled with attentive listeners, including DALLAS (40s) and MAC (10), sitting quietly in a pew.

PASTOR
"During ancient times, Israelites
would make sacrifices of all
kinds--grain, animals, even blood.
But today, we know that blood
sacrifice is no longer required."

The sermon concludes. The congregation begins to stir as they prepare to leave.

2. EXT. CHURCH FELLOWSHIP AREA - AFTERNOON

The church bustles with activity as congregates gather and plop iceberg lettuce on their plastic plates. Dallas and Mac stand awkwardly, each holding a plate of food. They stare at their plates, struggling to feel at ease.

A FRIENDLY MAN (50s), noticing their discomfort, approaches them with a welcoming smile.

FRIENDLY MAN

"Hey there, - hey (hey) where
y'all from?"

DALLAS

"Indiana."

FRIENDLY MAN

"Indiana, huh? Never been - Well,
welcome - Where are you living
now?"

DALLAS

"Branford."

The Friendly Man's face lights up.

FRIENDLY MAN

"No way! I'm in Branford too! We
have a BBQ going on tomorrow for
Labor Day. Come through if you
can"

Dallas nods politely, but he and Mac still seem out of
place.

In the distance, Mac spots MOLLY (12) and ASHER (10)
huddled over something. Asher holds a bunch of gear, while
Molly waves what looks like weather instruments in the air.

The Friendly Man points toward a MINI FRIDGE near the
coffee machine. A flyer pinned to the fridge reads: "23rd
Annual Branford Harvest Sea Festival."

Dominic enters the scene - giving a nod to the friendly
man.

DOMINIC

"See that? My cousin's in charge
of the whole thing. It's the Sea
Festival--a big deal around here.
We do it every year to raise money
for the Little League.

(MORE)

DOMINIC (CONT'D)

Borrow some stage equipment from the big arenas, get some local swashbuckle and jam bands to play... and of course, oysters for days. Not as famous as the Oyster Festival, but we hold our own."

Dallas listens politely, nodding along, but his attention drifts as the man continues to rattle on.

Makayla and Asher put something in a bag and put it under a tree. Mac doesn't say anything.

Cut To

The whole are at a church craft fair and they are

3. EXT. BRANFORD STREETS - EARLY EVENING

Dallas and Mac walk home from church. The journey is a bit of a hike. They pass through the tall beech grass, a little pizzeria, a small post office, a free library mail post, and a mix of nice homes with boats docked nearby--some pristine, others not so much.

CUT TO

EXT. MAC AND DALLAS HOUSE - BUTTERFLY LANE

They continue past it all, into their corner of the world--a quiet cul-de-sac near a land preserve and a bird sanctuary.

They finally arrive home, exhausted, taking in the sight of their new house as the wind begins to pick up.

The two look around at the property - and the property looks back at them.

Dallas peers in the distance at a kind of torn outdoor shed - he lifts peers the door open - and looks past all of the cobwebs and overgrown marsh that has entered it - he flicks the light switch - nothing.

Mac runs in the backyard and checks out the mailbox - which is irregular and begins to open

4. INT. NEW HOUSE - MAC'S ROOM - NIGHT

Later that night, Mac looks out his bedroom window. The fireflies are out again, their soft glow dotting the landscape. The wind rustles the tall grass outside, making the fireflies flicker and blur.

As Mac focuses on the distance, the fireflies' lights begin to resemble eyes watching from the darkness, unsettling him.

FADE OUT.

Monday

1. INT. SEDAN - MORNING

Dallas closes the garage door of a makeshift outdoor workshop.

DALLAS, holding his phone with the latest iOS, follows Google Maps as they drive through town in their old sedan. The car's engine hums steadily as they approach the school. DALLAS glances at MAC (10), who sits quietly in the passenger seat, a mix of nervousness and anticipation on his face.

DALLAS

"Hope - you have a good day"

Mac nods, gripping his backpack tightly as they pull up to the school.

2. EXT. SCHOOL ENTRANCE - MORNING

Mac steps out of the sedan, looking up at the imposing structure of his new school. The sounds of chattering students and the ringing of the school bell fill the air. Dallas watches him from the car, giving a final nod before driving off.

3. INT. CLASSROOM - MORNING

Mac enters the classroom, glancing around nervously at the unfamiliar faces. He finds an empty seat and sits down, trying to blend in. The TEACHER, a man in his early 30s, stands at the front of the room, beginning his introduction.

TEACHER

"Good morning, everyone. Welcome to a new school year - a fresh start is what we have in front of us - hey you paying attention - semester, we'll be exploring some exciting topics--weather patterns, the phases of the moon, and how the tides work."

Mac listens intently, but his attention is soon drawn to the window. Outside, the sky is overcast, and a field of wetlands with tall grass stretches out beyond the schoolyard.

4. EXT. SCHOOL YARD - AFTERNOON

Mac sees ASHER (10) from afar, accompanied by MOLLY (12), the same girl from church. Molly hands Asher a bag, and Asher discreetly puts it in his backpack. Mac watches the exchange, his curiosity piqued.

5. INT. SEDAN - AFTERNOON

Dallas picks up Mac after school. As they drive home, they realize that Asher and MAKAYLA are their neighbors. The TALKATIVE NEIGHBOR from church approaches their car, greeting them enthusiastically.

DOMINIC TALKATIVE NEIGHBOR

"Hey, Indiana! Guess what? These kids are neighbors! Small world, huh?"

As a group of neighborhood kids approaches Mac, one of them, a GIRL (10), speaks up.

MAKAYLA

"Hey, did you see me give Asher that bag?"

MAC

(nodding)
"Yeah."

Asher, looking sheepish, quickly walks away back to the house. Molly approaches Mac, looking him up and down.

MAKAYLA

(with a serious tone)

"Can I trust you?"

MAC

"I think so."

Molly glances over at Dallas and the Talkative Neighbor, then back to Mac.

MAKAYLA

"Ask your dad if it's okay for you to come over after dinner tonight. I'll have Asher come fetch you."

MAC

"Okay."

6. EXT. MOLLY'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Molly opens up the bag, revealing crab meat and bits of chicken. She hands some to Mac, along with sticks and string. The kids spend the night trying to lure something out in the wetlands, but nothing happens. A thunderstorm begins to brew, and the wind howls around them.

Suddenly, Molly's MOTHER calls her home, and the kids quickly pack up

7. INT. NEW HOUSE - MAC'S ROOM - NIGHT

That night, Mac looks out his bedroom window. The thunderstorm rages outside, the wind shaking the trees and tall grass. The power flickers, then goes out. Mac stares into the darkness, his eyes wide as he hears a loud crash from outside.

He presses his face closer to the glass, trying to make out what caused the noise, but all he can see are the blurred, glowing fireflies--now resembling eyes watching him through the storm.

FADE OUT.

Tuesday

1. EXT. HOUSE - MORNING

The morning sun casts long shadows as DALLAS steps outside, carrying a trash bag. He walks towards the bins, inspecting them for any sign of raccoon.

In the distance, MAC (10) sprints towards the mailbox, eager to grab the mail. As he opens the mailbox, he notices something unusual: a small burn mark on the ground. It's not large or round, but scattered and irregular.

Dallas notices Mac's hesitation and walks over, peering down at the mark.

Dallas frowns slightly but doesn't comment further. Mac collects the mail, and they head to the car.

Mac looks down - next to the lightning mark there is a single gem stone laying on the ground. Mac doesn't touch it - but goes into the car.

2. INT. CLASSROOM - DAY

The classroom buzzes with chatter as the TEACHER begins the day's lesson.

TEACHER

"For those who were up last night,
some of you may have heard a
distant rolling thunder - Charlie
- are you paying attention - Derek
- hey!

The teacher throws a book on the ground

TEACHER

I'm talking about boom thunder!
And how long does thunder make a
sound after lightrightg? Wake up
people these are life long
annedotes

Today, we'll be lightning forms--
phenomena that are particularly
interesting here on the coast."

As the teacher continues, Mac glances across the room at ASHER (10). The two exchange knowing looks. After class, Mac approaches Asher.

MAC

"Did you catch anything last
night?"

Asher nods no.

3. EXT. SCHOOL YARD - AFTERNOON

School has just let out, and students are pouring out of the building. Mac spots MAKAYLA (12) waiting near the edge of the playground. She walks up to him, a serious expression on her face.

MAKAYLA

"Can I trust you?"

MAC

"Yeah."

Molly looks around cautiously before speaking.

MAKAYLA

"Do you know about secret
professors?"

(MORE)

MAKAYLA (CONT'D)

(What)? - A long time ago, there was a group of professors who started a secret society - they were from Yale but they lived in Branford - okay - anyway - They would search these exact coasts - for specific crustaceans that they would find on specific rocks, during a certain time of the season, which is now"

MAC

"Why are you telling me this?"

MOLLY

"Because we have to be certain-- that we get the right bait""

MAC

"Bait for what?"

MOLLY

"The creature."

4. EXT. CORNER BEACH - DUSK

The golden light of the setting sun bathes the beach in a warm glow. Molly, Asher, and Mac arrive with flashlights and ziplock bags. They begin collecting small crustaceans from the rocks, carefully placing them in the bags with a bit of seawater.

Molly finds Mac alone and begins to talk to him.

MAC and MOLLY sit on a driftwood log, the silence between them heavy. The distant sound of waves fills the air.

MAKAYLA

(after a long silence)

"What happened to your mom?"

MAC

(speaking softly)

"She died a long time ago. She got sick when I was two... and died when I was three."

MAKAYLA

"That's cool - my mom too - (pause) - so Why did you move here?"

MAC

"My dad got a job at Yale"

MAKAYLA

What does your dad do?

MAC

He does physics and nuclear theoretical stuff.

The atmosphere is tense. Strange, wild sounds echo in the distance, making the kids jump.

ASHER

"What was that?"

The kids freeze, glancing around. **MAKAYLA** grabs out a small audio recorder that she has - and motions for the rest of the crew to stay silent - but after the second cry - without a word, they quickly gather their things and rush to their bikes.

5. EXT. MAC'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Mac pedals home as fast as he can, the events of the evening still fresh in his mind. When he arrives, he sees Dallas outside, watching the bird feeder.

Without hesitation, Mac runs to him and gives him a tight hug.

DALLAS

"What happened?"

Before Mac can answer, they both hear the strange sound together--carried on the wind from the direction of the beach. Dallas looks out into the darkness, his concern growing.

6. INT. NEW HOUSE - DINING ROOM - NIGHT

Dallas and Mac sit down on their couch for dinner. Tension still lingers in the air, and they eat quietly. The distant sounds of the night mix with the clatter of utensils, adds to the growing sense of unease.

On the TV is the Weatherman - the same weatherman that was out in the day before. Talking about a hurricane that is quickly making a case. And how that is is hurricane season. Be on the look out

*Develop this scene - watch footage of weathermen

FADE OUT.

Wednesday**1. EXT. DRIVEWAY - EVENING**

Dallas and Mac drive to a neighbor's house for dinner. On the radio forecasts the evening weather and advertises the big Branford Sea Harvest Festival this next week.

CUT TO

2. EXT. MOLLY'S BACKYARD DECK PARTY - EVENING

The warm glow of the setting sun casts a golden light over the backyard. Laughter and the sounds of a BBQ sizzle in the background as neighbors mingle on the deck. Dallas stands with Dominic, a talkative neighbor, who is enthusiastically chatting away.

DOMINIC

(excitedly gesturing with
his a fork of ziti)

Yeah, yeah, Hugo--my cousin--
throws an annual charity event
every summer. You'd really like
him--his daughter's into all that
sea stuff too. You and your son
should join us. The kids can play,
and we can all hang out.

Dallas smiles politely, but it's clear Dominic's energy is a bit overwhelming. Mac stands nearby, quietly listening to the conversation but not engaging, his eyes occasionally drifting to the edge of the backyard.

In the background, **MAKAYLA (12)**, carrying her backpack, approaches Dominic, and hugs him quickly. Molly then steps back, looking over at Mac as she pulls the straps of her backpack tighter.

MAKAYLA

(to Dominic)

Dad, I'm heading to the back with the others. I'll be back later.

DOMINIC

Okay, Just stay close - we have a lot of people over and you we're about to eat.

MAKAYLA

Yes, Dad.

Molly glances at Mac, making brief eye contact before turning and heading toward the far end of the backyard. She disappears into the twilight, her figure silhouetted against the setting sun as she makes her way toward the coast.

Dallas watches her leave, sensing something in the air, but he doesn't say anything. Dominic resumes his animated conversation, drawing Dallas back into the moment.

DOMINIC

So this charity event...

3. EXT. MOLLY'S FAR BACKYARD BY THE COAST - AFTERNOON

The deck party continues, the noise and laughter distant now as **MAC** wanders alone near the far end of Molly's backyard, which stretches all the way to the coast stuck in the last dog days of summer.

Mac stands still, staring out at the water. The waves roll in thickly, and their soft crash against the rocks fills the air. Mac scans the grass, looking for the mysterious eyes and then back to Makayla - who is pointing a telescope down at a certain part of the coastline.

Suddenly, he hears a faint whimper--a distant cry that sounds like an animal in pain, far off in the wilderness. The nautical sounds engulf him, heightening his fear. The grass rustles, but it's unclear if it's the wind or something else.

Frightened, Mac takes a step back, ready to head back to the safety of the deck party. But before he can leave, he's stopped by a group of kids emerging from the fog--**MOLLY, ASHER**, and a few others, including **MISTY (13)**, one of the older girls. They move with purpose, their faces serious.

Molly steps forward, her eyes focused on Mac.

MAKAYLA
(firm, yet with a hint of
urgency)
Mac, give me that shovel.

Mac hesitates for a moment, unsure of what they're planning, but the determined look on Molly's face convinces him. He nods and runs to grab the shovel that's leaning against a nearby tree.

As he hands it over, Molly turns to the group, her expression shifting from determination to leadership.

MAKAYLA
(lowering her voice, as
if revealing a secret
plan)
Alright, we need to move quickly.
The storm's coming, and if we're
going to lure it out, this is our
only shot.
(MORE)

MAKAYLA (CONT'D)

Asher, you're on lookout. Misty,
make sure the bait's ready. We'll
set the traps near the tall grass,
just like we planned.

The other kids nod, following Molly's lead without question. Mac watches them, both intrigued and nervous. He knows they're about to do something dangerous, but the pull of the mystery--the chance to finally confront the creature--keeps him from backing out.

Molly catches Mac's eye, sensing his hesitation.

MAKAYLA

(softly, with a hint of
reassurance)

You with us, Mac?

Mac takes a deep breath and nods.

Molly smiles briefly, then turns back to the group.

MAKAYLA

Let's go.

The kids, led by Molly, move deeper into the night, toward the farthest reaches of the backyard, where the grass is tallest and the coast drops off into the sea. The fog thickens, and the air grows colder, but they press on.

4. EXT. CORNER BEACH - NIGHT

The crew scours the corner beach, searching for evidence of lightning strikes and other burn marks. They find nothing. Molly suggests they head to "the fort."

MAC

"You guys have a fort?"

5. EXT. THE FORT - LATE AFTERNOON

The kids flock to their hideaway--a makeshift fort hidden among the tall grass. They begin laying traps made of various forms of food tied to driftwood sticks outside the fort.

MAKAYLA

"The creatures are likely to come from the sea, though my grandfather always said they come from the grass. They come from the sea first, then go into the grass."

JEFFERSON

(skeptical)

"How could you possibly know that?"

MAKAYLA

"Shut up Jefferson - you're lucky your even here."

The two exchange glances for a while.

A debate ensues among the kids about how the creature would behave on land, how it would move, and how it would scatter about the tall grass.

MISTY

(setting up a camera)

"Let's see if we can catch something on film."

Molly watches Misty (Age 13) sets up an old digital point and shoot camera while the rest of the group prepares the bait, waiting for the thunderstorm to roll in.

6. EXT. OUTSIDE NEIGHBORHOOD CORNER GRASS - DOG DAYS IN THE TALL GRASS

The crew stand idle by the tall grass and just stare at a while at it. Asher looks at the clouds. Jefferson looks at the cars and the neighbors looking. Makayla looks head on. And Mac ignores all and looks for the eyes.

JEFFERSON

"Your grandfather was just writing those stories to make you laugh. He didn't believe in that stuff."

MISTY

Jefferson - - Mom says we have to go back to the party.

MAKAYLA

"No--he actually did."

JEFFERSON

Did what?

MAKAYLA

Believe

JEFFERSON

In what?

MISTY

Jefferson, we should get going -common - we have to go back - mom just texted me we got to go now.

CUT TO

EXT. EXT PARTY

The kids hang back to the party. Mac approaches Dallas who is standing by himself in the hallway of the house - looking at family portraits - looking at wall mounted family portraits - photos of when the kids were little and what not.

CUT TO

EXT. TALL BEACHY - DUSK

That night it is windy. Dallas makes his way to the makeshift shed workshop - and flips the light on - revealing a small wooden desk with wires and instruments - and notebooks.

Dallas turns on a computer and begins to type 4tran

Thursday

1. INT. HOUSE - MORNING

Dallas parks the car and realizes that Mac forgot his lunch bag. He grabs it - as he makes his way inside- the sound of the breeze from the Long Island Sound rustling through the trees. He pauses, looking out at the sky before stepping through the door. From the corner of his eye - he spots a burn mark near the mailbox.

2. EXT. SCHOOL PLAYGROUND - AFTERNOON

Later that afternoon at recess, Mac finds Makayla standing by the soccer net, staring at some strange burn marks on the grass. She turns to him, her expression serious.

MAKAYLA

"My grandfather told me last night that it's happening. I can show you."

Mac hesitates but then nods.

MAC

"I thought your grandfather died."

1. INT. YOUTH GROUP CLASS - AFTERNOON

Mac looks around and notices that some of his classmates are also his Sunday School classmates. The Youth Pastor begins handing out papers on the topic of ancient Israelites and what we can learn from their mistaken ways of seeking atonement.

After the class, the Youth Pastor notices Mac sitting alone and goes over to console him.

2. EXT. CHURCH PARKING LOT

Mac sits alone as the rest of the kids parents pick up their from Youth Group. He watches everyone and their families go into their various mini vans.

The Youth Pastor notices mac sitting alone and joins him on the stoop.

JERRY

Mac, you seem deep in thought. Can I sit?

MAC

Yeah.

JERRY

Is your Dad coming to pick you up?

MAC

Yeah.

JERRY

That's good - that's good. First week - new town - new school - how's it going?

MAC

Good.

JERRY

Ah - that's good...

A group of seagulls

Yeah - I remember coming here from Georgia - wasn't used to these New England winters. But that's was away.

Mac continues to look onward.

MAC

Do you think there are creatures in other worlds?

JERRY

What's that?

MAC

The handout you gave before - and the talk after - you said that the *** came from *** to serve God.

JERRY

I did - yes.

MAC

So are there still creatures in this world?

JERRY

Hmmm. Well, maybe you could think of the creatures of the deep waters that we're still figuring out. I think it's easy for us to get hung up on the logistics - - but if you think about it there are still - - ancient things - things we don't understand - we're discovering about dinosaurs and whatnot.

MAC

That's not what I mean. Makayla was talking about these creatures that she has been seeing in the tall grass - and now her and Asher and me are taking pictures of the tall grass.

JERRY

Makayla is interesting huh - she's come a long way since her father died.

MAC

I thought it was her grandfather that died.

JERRY

Is that what she said?

Dallas approaches and walks outside. He goes up to Jerry and shakes his hand - thank you - sorry I was late.

DALLAS

Sorry I was late - thank you - Mac walks into the car.

7. EXT. MAC'S HOUSE - NIGHT

That night, Mac steps outside and sees Dallas grilling. The smoke from the grill rises and catches the light, casting eerie shadows. Mac looks beyond the borders of their property, his gaze fixated on the tall grass swaying in the breeze.

Dallas notices him staring and follows his gaze, looking at the tall grass as well.

8. INT. MAC'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Later, Mac walks back inside to find Dallas staring at the weather TV. Dallas notices Mac and gets up. The two sit together by the TV. Off in the distance - the wind pulls up.

9. EXT. MAC'S HOUSE - NIGHT

That night, as they prepare for bed, a strange sound echoes through the house. The wind begins to pick up, rattling the windows. Dallas looks out into the night, the tall grass swaying ominously.

Outside there is a

10. EXT. MAC'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Dallas steps outside into the thunderstorm to make sure everything is secure. The wind howls around him as he checks the perimeter, a sense of unease settling in.

FADE OUT.

FRIDAY.

1. INT. MAC'S HOUSE - MORNING

The next morning, the storm has passed, but the air is still heavy with the remnants of the previous night's events.

Dallas looks out and finds the seed from the bird feeder scattered about. Mac looks for the rocks.

2. INT. School Class

TEACHER

Not sure if you folks have been
noticing the weather has been
acting sproadic - johnny -
sproadic

3. INT. Saturday Morning - Around the Corner at the Beach

The crew go wild with their bikes down the road - past the post office - and ride their bikes among the tiny costal sidewalks.

Media Class - School HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - AFTERNOON

The crew--Makayla , Mac, and a few other kids--gather around a computer.

They stand over a software editor, DaVinci Resolve, going frame by frame through various cameras and footage, scanning for any sign of eyes or other mysterious figures. Misty hands molly another camera - and she puts it into an SD card.

Nothing comes up.

*Jefferson to Makayla - - hey - you showed Mac that dumb book yet?

SATURDAY #2

SATURDAY MORNING

EXT. MAC'S HOUSE - MORNING

Dallas builds a bird feeder and looks at his creation. He then goes through the bucket and begins to do little gardening things.

He struggles at first to get started - but then in time he does and gets to it.

Mac looks in the bucket and finds an old fishing wire and a ring - he begins to make a little ring toss on a tree - across the street from the tall grass.

Mac plays for a while * put this earlier and later??**

Mac gets his bike and rides off.

CUT TO

EXT. MAKAYLA'S HOUSE - MORNING

Mac parks his bike outside Makayla and Ashers home. The talkative neighbor Dominic answers

DOMININC

Oh whats up Mr. Mac - what's shaking my friend? How's your dad?

MAC

He's okay

DOMINIC

You should tell him to call me sometime. You looking for Makayla?

MAC
Yeah - I have her *Item.

Makayla comes running down the stairs with laptops, cam
corders, (anything else she gets from ebay)

NT. MAKAYLA'S GRANDPA'S STUDY - DAY

Dust floats in the beams of light filtering through the worn curtains. The room is filled with old dvd covers, play houses, dust soaked blankets covering books, book chests, giving the impression of a horder is a horder books, maps, and trinkets from a life spent studying the strange and unknown. Makayla, Mac, and Asher all sit around a dusty laptop with a basic movie editor software.

MAKAYLA
(whispering, as if afraid
to disturb the silence)
I was thinking we could
triangulate the creature

MAC
How do you know all of this

MAKAYLA
Can I trust you?

Makayla pulls out an old, leather-bound journal from a shelf. The cover is embossed with strange, swirling symbols that seem familiar. He opens it carefully, revealing handwritten notes, sketches, and weather observations.

The kids gather around as Makayla flips through the pages. The journal is filled with cryptic entries, but one passage catches their attention. It's dated decades ago, when Makayla's grandfather was a young boy.

MAKAYLA
(excited, whispering)
This is a story our Grandfather
wrote down. But it's not just any
story --this is real. He saw them.

The kids exchange nervous glances. Makayla clears her throat and begins reading aloud, her voice filled with a mix of awe and fear.

MAKAYLA

(reading)

"Cold - summer night in September
- Wednesday - 1925 - cold windy -
outside - near the coast - far off
in the distance I stood with my
father - and we both saw the
stones -

they were close at first - when I
first saw the eyes - standing in
the distance - I noted that the
sunset seemed darker than most -
not that it was night time. Night
- night , darker than most nights.
I was a boy, wandering through the
woods near town... chasing after
something I couldn't quite see,
but I knew it was there..."

MAC

(leaning in, intrigued)

ASHER

(glancing around
nervously)

Keep reading, Makayla.

Makayla turns the page, revealing a rough sketch of the
costal tall grass and strange symbols drawn in the margins.
Rock formations in little "karen" like places.

MAKAYLA

(continuing)

"The woods were dense I followed a
faint, melodic hum... It sounded
like a lullaby, but different--
eerie and unearthly..."

MAKAYLA

(reading)

"I followed the sound deeper into
the woods until I found them...
Creatures, not quite human, not
quite animal--something in
between. They moved through the
shadows, their bodies shimmering
like mist..."

Makayla flips to a page with a rough drawing of the creatures--figures that seem both beautiful and terrifying, with glowing eyes and ethereal forms.

MAKAYLA

(reading)

"They saw me too - and for a while
- we stood at each other "

MAKAYLA

(pausing, showing the
sketch)

This is what he saw. These...
things... They were real.

MAC

(awed, barely above a
whisper)

No way...

ASHER

(nervous, looking at the
drawing)

They look... like ghosts - with
just glowing eyes.

Makayla nods and continues reading, her voice growing more intense.

MAKAYLA

(reading)

"They were performing a ritual,
placing stones and plants in a
pattern on the ground. The wind
picked up, but they didn't seem to
notice. Their hum grew louder,
almost like they were summoning
something... And then, everything
went silent."

Wind looks out the window - it is getting windy.

MAC
I think I should go home

MAKAYLA
What do you mean?

ASHER
It's getting windy.

MAC
My dad's been worried about the weather.

MAKAYLA
(determined, closing the journal)
We have to find out what happened next. If Grandpa saw them, then we can too. We just need to figure out what they want... before it's too late. I think they want the chicken on the stick

MAC
Okay - when do you want to do this?

MAKAYLA
We have to wait on the weather - for a true thunderstorm.

MAKAYLA (V.O.)
(continuing)
"One of the creatures stepped forward, extending a hand... I was frozen in place, unable to move or look away from its glowing eyes... I thought it was the end, but then..."

Makayla trails off, turning the page, but the rest of the entry is smudged, the words barely legible.

MAKAYLA
(frustrated)
I can't read the rest... It's like he never finished it.

MAC
(frowning)
Or maybe... maybe something stopped him from finishing it.

The kids sit in silence for a moment, absorbing what they've just read. The realization hits them--Makayla's grandfather encountered the creatures, and now, they're following the same path.

ASHER
(nodding, still nervous
but resolved)
Maybe they like the chicken on the
stick.... The crabs do

CUT TO:

EXT. MAC'S BIKE RIDE HOME

Mac looks as he rides his bike along the tall grass Mac looks for eyes.

As he walks home - he notices a dog in the distance acting weird - barking at the tall grass - something in the distance - with nothing seemingly going on - Mac rides faster.

EXT. MAC'S HOUSE - OUTSIDE GARAGE

He finds Dallas outside taking a measurement of the weather - he goes and watches his dad - and his dad explains a bit how it works.

Outside in the distance - a camera crew again looks out on something in the tall grass.

Mac is curious and walks over to see what is going on.

As he walks over - he sees another stone on the ground next to the other gemstone - he doesn't touch them but goes inside that night.

INT. DINNER TIME

Mac and Dallas watch TV as they eat.

News about the hurricane and how it is approaching landfall is all over the horizon.

Hurricane season they are calling it -

Mac looks out the window for the eyes - and sees a flicker at night.

That night it is windy and Mac wanders his eyes across the street at the tall grass.

SUNDAY #2

INT. CHURCH SANCTUARY

The church is buzzing with the talk of the town - apparently a very strange event happened to everything the night before.

Mac looks at different congregates hovering around a coffee pot as an older gentlemen hands out welcome cards. On the screen there are announcements for upcoming Harvest Festival - that the church is going to be a part of and run the kids crafts table apparently - volunteers are needed.

Mac and Dallas walk into the pew and sit behind a baby that stares at Mac

The piano begins

PASTOR JERRY

Please find a seat - our call to worship this morning is from the book of Isiah - Chapter 52 verse 25.

The projector screen reads.

Mac looks around for Makayla and Asher but they are not here this morning.

EXT. CHURCH OUTSIDE FELLOWSHIP LUNCH

Mac approaches Jerry and asks him if he has seen Makayla or Asher.

MAC

I was with them yesterday.

PASTOR JERRY

They were supposed to help out
with the nursery room - all good -
just not like their father to not
bring them - okay - sorry - just
wanted to make sure they were okay

EXT. BEACH HOUSE

Mac and Dallas approach their home from their walk. Mac
runs over to the mailbox and.

Mac looks around the neighbors house but sees their car
gone.

MONDAY #2

INT. SCHOOL

Mac checks the stones - they are still there. School begins
and ends. The teacher talks about the weather more. Asher
and Mac eat silently during lunch. Makayla's father takes
them home.

Mac goes home that night and sees Makayla sitting alone -

EXT. MAKAYLA'S HOUSE

MAKAYLA

I saw the creature last night.

Mac's eyes widen.

MAKAYLA

It came.

Mac's eyes widen.

Asher's in the hospital.

MAC

Really?

MAKAYLA

We were going to get the footage before it got dark - and as we were approaching the camera - He saw the creature too and he ran away and he broke his leg - I stood there and stood still... we were there until late - and I was tired so I asked my dad if I could stay home from school today and he said it was okay - he took off work himself - Ashers in the hospital and we're going to go over after we shower and visit him - he should be back tomorrow.

MAC

Have you talked to him?

MAKAYLA

No - not really - I told him not to talk about what we were doing back there - as the adults would think would get all worried and start a big investigation and ruin our plans before they begin.

MAC

What do you see?

MAKAYLA

I saw eyes in the distance... And then - and then I don't know what happened - it was like - I was dreaming for a second - but then I woke up at it was gone - and Asher was crying in the distance.

MAC

Did you look at the footage?

Makayla Smiles.

CUT TO

INT. HALF-FINISHED BASEMENT COMPUTER ROOM

The crew look at a series of old CRT era laptops all haphazardly and hackerdly arranged - and then a big slow motion - and then nothing - and then asher crying - but a flash of light - and in the center as they zoom nothing - but as a filter is applied - some makeshift eyes appear

The dad comes downstairs and tells Makayla that they have to go - Mac needs to go home.

Cut to

EXT. MAC HOUSE

Dallas is out in the front yard looking at the gem stones and then he looks at Mac - Mac looks back - the two walk inside and check the wather.

TRANSITION INTO ACT 2 (

EXT. MAC'S HOUSE

School has been cancelled. Dallas turns on the TV - School has been cancelled - the hurricane is set to land fall.

Mac looks out the window outside and sees a bright sunny sky as Makayla and Asher arrive on bikes.

MAKAYLA
Can we use your sink*?

INT. MAC'S KITCHEN

Dallas stands over the sink and washes dirt off potatoes - but moves out of the way when Makayla storms in.

Makayla begins to rattling on as she takes out an old metal instrument and begins to wash the dirt off of it.

MAKAYLA
I have a plan - I think the
creatures have landed - I believe
that they have come with the storm
- and now - now, we are going to
mark them.

Dallas putters around the kitchen - looking for a towel to dry his hands. and looks for a towel to wipe his hands.

Makayla hands Mac the instrument - still soaking wet -
Dallas hands Mac the cloth.

Makayla and Dallas lock eyes. Asher bumps into the two as he carries a box full of instruments. They look like meat thermometers - because they are.

MAC
How are you feeling Asher?

ASHER
Better.

CUT TO

EXT. MAC'S BACKYARD

Makayla shows Mac, Asher and now Dallas who is watching - her dig a little hole in the ground and plants the device in.

VO MAKAYLA
Creatures, like animals, give off heat... These are set to pick up temperature changes in the ground.

Makayla grabs something from her backpack - it is a interesting electrical device - she puts it on the ground as she searches for more materials and Dallas picks it up. Holding it close and inspecting it.

ASHER
Does it work?

Dallas looks at Asher in a concerned look. Dallas takes it into his workshop outback - as the children continue.

MAKAYLA
He's going to fix it right? I think that one works - he'll figure it out. Here's another (she tosses it to Mac) - it's a trail cam - when we get the notice that the ground temperature changes - we'll know when on the timeline to go look for the footage. These are trail cams baby - grade A stuff - they will detect night vision and anything else.

Mac looks at the trail cam.

MAC
Where do you want to hang them?

CUT TO

EXT. MAC'S BACKYARD - THE TREE TO HANG THE WIRE

Mac begins to use his fishing line kit to delicately tie the device down.

CUT TO

EXT. MAKAYLA'S BACKYARD

Mac hangs another deer cam - as Asher plants meat thermometers towards the edge of the tall grass.

VO MAKAYLA

The creatures give off heat - just
like any other creatures - these
are

CUT TO

EXT. NEIGHBORHOOD

The kids ride their bikes around the coastal town - Makayla looks for another spot - Asher and Mac ride together.

ASHER

Do you think they're really
creatures in the tall grass?

MAC

(Looking at Asher)
Do you?

ASHER

I think so - Makayla seems to
think so at least.

EXT. MAC'S OUTSIDE - DUSK

The children arrive. Dallas comes outside with the device in his hand - he hands it over to Makayla. The two exchange looks and Makayla and Asher ride off.

Mac and Dallas go inside without saying much - and Dallas goes into the kitchen and continues to wash his potatoes.

INT. MAC'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

Mac looks up at the stars on his bedroom ceiling - he looks at a picture of his mom - and then a faint cry is heard into the distance.

It is like a cry of a wounded animal and then ceases to stop. Mac looks outside the window at the tall grass - and at first sees nothing - but then sees the eyes.

He slowly moves back into bed - and then goes out and looks out the window again - but nothing.

Another cry is heard - this time it is followed by a big crash.

Dallas wakes up and reaches Mac to the door.

The two look outside the window together - out in their backyard at the tall grass.

They hear another faint whimper and some grass move in the distant shadows.

EXT. BACKYARD - EARLY MORNING

MAC stands near the edge of the backyard, staring out into the **TALL GRASS** swaying in the breeze. The morning is unusually still, but there's something in the air--an unsettling quiet before the storm. **DALLAS** is nearby, fixing a loose board on the back fence, his face tight with concern.

DALLAS

(calling out to Mac)

Hey, you doing okay out there?

Mac is distracted, his eyes drawn to something near the **EDGE OF THE GRASS**. His brow furrows, noticing the faint outline of **BURN MARKS** in the dirt, just like the ones he saw before. He glances back at his dad.

MAC

(hesitant)

Dad... I think you should see this.

Dallas walks over, wiping his hands on his jeans, and follows Mac's gaze down to the burn marks. His face tenses as he kneels down, running a hand over the **SINGED GRASS**.

DALLAS

(concerned)

What the hell... these weren't here last night.

The burn marks form a rough circle, and in the middle, a strange **STONE** is half-buried in the dirt, etched with faint **SYMBOLS**.

MAC

(quietly)

They're getting closer.

Dallas stands, his eyes narrowing at the tall grass.

DALLAS

(firm)

We need to stay on top of this. Don't tell Makayla yet. Not until we figure out what's going on.

EXT. HOSPITAL PARKING LOT - EVENING

The sky is now a dark, ominous gray. **MAKAYLA**, **ASHER**, and **MAC** step out of the hospital doors, a gust of wind hitting them as they cross the lot. The storm is moving in fast--rain begins to mist the streets.

MAKAYLA walks ahead, looking distracted as she pulls out her phone. A picture of the **BURN MARKS** from earlier catches her eye, and she zooms in on the **SYMBOLS** carved into the stone. Her expression tightens in thought.

MAC and **ASHER** share a look but don't say anything just yet. The wind gusts harder, pushing them forward.

EXT. MAIN STREET - CONTINUOUS

As they walk down the street, **STREETLIGHTS FLICKER** ominously, and an electronic sign blinks with a warning: **STORM ALERT: HURRICANE WARNINGS IN EFFECT. EVACUATE BY MIDDAY TOMORROW.**

The town around them is buzzing with activity. People hurry in and out of shops, their arms filled with **SUPPLIES**--water bottles, canned food, flashlights. A family drives by, their car packed with suitcases, a small dog peering out from the back window.

MAKAYLA

(under her breath, staring at her phone)

There's something we're missing...

She zooms in on the symbols again, deep in thought. **MAC** glances at her nervously, knowing what she's about to figure out. Before he can say anything, they reach the end of the street.

EXT. STORMY STREET - CONTINUOUS

As they continue, the storm grows louder. The **DISTANT HUM OF SIRENS** echoes down the street. **POLICE CARS** roll by, blaring instructions through their loudspeakers.

POLICE LOUDSPEAKER

Attention! Evacuation is mandatory for all coastal residents. Please seek shelter inland and avoid unnecessary travel.

MAKAYLA slows her pace, her eyes suddenly drawn to something on the ground. There, in the middle of the sidewalk, is another faint outline of **BURN MARKS**--similar to the ones she saw in the backyard.

MAKAYLA

(startled, to Mac)
Did you see these before?

MAC hesitates, unsure of how to respond.

MAC

(quietly)
I didn't want to worry you... but they've been showing up more. Around the house, around town. Dad didn't want me to tell you until we figured it out.

Makayla's eyes widen as she kneels down, her fingers brushing over the marks. She looks back at the **STONE** in her hand from earlier, realizing the connection.

MAKAYLA

(determined)
It's all connected... the burn marks, the creatures, the storm. We have to act fast.

ASHER

(nervously)
The storm's already here, Mak. What are we supposed to do?

MAKAYLA stands up, her mind racing as she looks out at the town. The storm is growing stronger, but she's piecing it together now.

MAKAYLA

We have to stop it. We have to finish what my grandfather started.

EXT. TOWN STREETS - CONTINUOUS

As the rain picks up, **PEOPLE** rush past them, boarding up windows and preparing for the worst. **LOUDSPEAKERS** blare evacuation orders, and the distant rumble of thunder grows louder.

MAKAYLA

(to the others)

We don't have much time. We have to get back to the field-- the creatures are trying to tell us something.

ASHER

(voice shaking)

And if they don't want to help us?

MAKAYLA

(with quiet determination)

Then we make them.

They hurry off into the growing storm, leaving the town behind as the first drops of heavy rain begin to fall.

Makayla pauses, glancing up at the dark sky. The clouds swirl above the town like an ominous shadow, casting a gray tint over everything.

MAC

(quietly, looking around)

Something's different. It's like the whole town knows it's coming.

Makayla nods but doesn't say anything. Her mind is racing, but her focus stays on the **pictures**. She looks at the **stones** again, zooming in on the etchings.

They walk past a **gas station**, where cars are lined up, waiting for fuel. Drivers are growing restless, honking their horns as the pumps struggle to keep up with demand. A **cashier** frantically closes the store's doors, flipping the "OPEN" sign to "CLOSED."

MAKAYLA

(murmuring to herself, distracted by her phone)

We're missing something...

As they pass a **group of people** standing outside a **hardware store**, the kids overhear fragments of conversation.

The words "**storm**," "**freak weather**," and "**never seen it this bad**" hang in the air.

OLD MAN

(to no one in particular)
I've lived through plenty of hurricanes, but this one's different. Feels like the earth itself is shifting.

The **wind gusts** again, stronger this time. A loose newspaper blows across the street, slapping against a lamp post. **Tree branches** sway violently overhead, and a distant rumble of thunder rolls in, making a few people glance nervously at the sky.

ASHER

(frowning, noticing the tension in the air)
Everyone's acting like the storm is gonna end everything. They're scared.

Makayla tucks her phone away and looks around at the town. A **neighborhood dog**, usually barking from behind a fence, sits quietly, ears pinned back, sensing something off in the air.

A MOTHER rushes her kids into their car, glancing back over her shoulder as if something might be following them. She slams the car door shut with a little too much force, the fear palpable.

Makayla catches sight of an **older woman** sitting on her porch, rocking slowly in a chair. Her face is stoic, but her eyes are locked on the darkening sky, as if waiting for something inevitable.

MAC

(softly)
It's not just the storm, is it?

MAKAYLA

No. It's not.

They stop at the corner of the street. In the distance, by the **waterfront**, they see **news vans** parked near the shore, cameras rolling, capturing footage of the rising tide and the ominous clouds hanging over the ocean.

NEWS REPORTER

(on camera, her voice carried by the wind)
"The hurricane is predicted to make landfall tomorrow night, with dangerous winds and severe flooding. Local authorities are urging residents to evacuate immediately. Back to you, Jack."

Behind the reporter, **waves crash** harder against the rocks than they should, even at high tide.

Makayla clenches her fists, determination setting in.

MAKAYLA

We need to hurry. The storm's not the only thing they should be afraid of. We're running out of time.

Without another word, they continue walking, the tension building around them as the storm's first true winds start to tear through the town, whipping up leaves and trash as the distant hum of thunder echoes like a countdown.

EXT. HARDWARE STORE - EVENING

The wind howls as **Makayla, Mac, and Asher** approach the **hardware store**. The lights inside flicker, and the "**OPEN**" sign dangles precariously on a loose nail, swaying in the wind. The windows are already boarded halfway up, but people are still rushing in and out, grabbing last-minute supplies.

MAKAYLA

(quickly)

Come on, we need more posts and wire.

The three kids push through the front doors, the bell above the door jingling as they enter.

INT. HARDWARE STORE - EVENING

The store is **chaotic**, with aisles cluttered by people grabbing everything from **flashlights** to **sandbags**. **Generators** and **tarps** are piled up near the registers. A few **lanterns** cast long shadows over the narrow aisles.

As they walk in, **EVERYONE** seems to recognize Makayla. **Regular customers** glance at her, offering brief nods or murmurs under their breath.

CUSTOMER #1

(whispers to another)

That's Makayla... Ed's granddaughter, right?

CUSTOMER #2

(nods, packing his cart)

Yeah. Always knows what she's doing, that one.

MAKAYLA

(to Mac and Asher, focused)

Stay close, I know where we can find the posts.

She leads them down the aisles, moving with purpose. **Mac** glances nervously around, sensing the eyes of the customers following them.

They weave through the crowd until they reach the **back of the store**, where the **outdoor gear** and **construction supplies** are lined up.

MAKAYLA

(pointing)
There, grab those metal posts.

MAC

(grabbing a bundle)
Got it.

ASHER struggles to carry a spool of **fishing wire** as he stumbles, almost knocking over a display of **duct tape**.

ASHER

(awkwardly)
Why do we need so much of this stuff?

MAKAYLA

(loading her arms with supplies)
We're not just catching a storm. We're going to mark exactly where the creatures are. When the ground heats up, we'll know.

As she picks up the **wire**, the **STORE OWNER**, a gruff man in his 60s named **ED**, emerges from behind the counter. He watches Makayla, a **knowing look** in his eyes.

ED

(slightly amused)
Makayla. You stockpiling for the hurricane, or something else?

MAKAYLA

(without missing a beat)
Both. You got any more of those long stakes in the back? The ones you usually keep for fencing?

ED

(nods, walking toward the back room)
A couple left. Let me grab 'em for you.

ASHER shifts uncomfortably as the **customers** continue to glance at them, whispers buzzing throughout the store.

CUSTOMER #3

(muttering to another)
She's always been strange, that one. Always poking around the old places by the coast.

CUSTOMER #4

(frowning)

If anyone knows what's really going on, it's her.

ED returns with a bundle of **metal stakes**, handing them to **Makayla** with a cautious smile.

ED

(softly, almost warning)

Be careful out there, Makayla. This storm ain't like the ones before.

MAKAYLA

(nods, determined)

I know, Ed. We'll be careful.

She takes the stakes, leading Mac and Asher back toward the **checkout counter**.

INT. HARDWARE STORE - CHECKOUT COUNTER - EVENING

As they approach the counter, **Makayla** dumps the metal stakes, fishing wire, and posts onto the conveyor belt. The **CASHIER**, a young guy, raises an eyebrow at the unusual supplies.

CASHIER

(half-joking)

Planning on building something out there?

MAKAYLA

(smirking)

You could say that.

Behind them, more **customers** enter, the sound of wind rattling the door as it slams shut. The **sirens** outside grow louder, heightening the sense of urgency.

EXT. HARDWARE STORE - NIGHT

The kids step outside, their arms full of supplies. The sky has darkened further, the winds more violent now, as the first sheets of rain begin to fall.

MAKAYLA

(looking at the sky)

We need to hurry. We're running out of time.

They rush to their **bikes**, strapping the metal stakes and fishing wire to the frames as best they can. **Mac** and **Asher** exchange a glance, both feeling the weight of the moment.

EXT. STREETS - NIGHT

They ride through the nearly deserted streets, the wind pushing them sideways. **Streetlights flicker** as the storm continues to build, but **Makayla** presses on, determined, leading the charge back toward their **setup site**.

EXT. MAC'S BACKYARD - NIGHT

The wind whips through the tall grass as **Makayla, Mac, and Asher** work in the growing darkness. The trees sway violently, their branches bending under the force of the approaching storm. The **sky** above is darkening rapidly, heavy clouds swirling ominously as the storm begins to bear down.

Makayla crouches near the **edge of the grass**, driving a **metal post** into the ground with a **hammer**. Beside her, **Mac** is carefully unwinding a spool of **fishing wire**, his hands moving methodically despite the gusts of wind pushing him off balance.

ASHER, standing a little farther back, holds the **meat thermometers** they plan to use to monitor temperature changes in the ground. He looks around nervously, his eyes flicking between the tall grass and the shadows that seem to dance in the darkness.

ASHER

(shouting over the wind)
Are we sure this is going to work?

MAKAYLA

(voice steady)
It has to. The creatures give off heat--these will pick it up. We'll know exactly where they are when the storm hits.

Mac finishes securing the **fishing wire**, tying it tightly around the **metal post**. He glances up at the **dark sky**, the low rumble of **thunder** echoing in the distance.

MAC

(looking at Makayla)
And what if it doesn't? What if they don't show up?

MAKAYLA

(grimly, not stopping her work)
They will.

The burn marks have been getting closer. They're here, somewhere.

She moves to another spot, planting another **metal post** in the ground, driving it in with quick, practiced movements. **Mac** follows her lead, stringing more **fishing wire** between the posts, creating a delicate web around the perimeter of the **backyard**.

ASHER

(still nervous)

I'm not sure I want to know when they show up.

MAKAYLA

(quickly, focused)

We have to know, Ash. If we don't, the storm's just a distraction. They could be out there waiting--waiting for us to slip up.

Dallas steps out of the **workshop**, holding the device they'd given him to fix. He inspects it one last time, nodding to himself before walking over to the kids.

DALLAS

(calling out)

Here. It's ready.

He hands the device to **Makayla**, who takes it with a quick nod of thanks. She kneels on the ground, setting the **device** in the center of their setup, connecting the **fishing wire** to it. It hums softly as it powers up, the lights flickering in response to the rising **wind**.

DALLAS

(slightly concerned, watching the setup)

You really think this'll catch them?

MAKAYLA

(confidently)

It'll work. We've been tracking them for weeks. They're drawn to the heat--this is the only way we'll know when they're here.

Dallas watches her for a moment, then nods, stepping back as the kids continue setting the last of the traps.

EXT. MAC'S BACKYARD - LATER

The traps are all in place now. **Fishing wire** crisscrosses between the **metal posts**, glistening in the faint moonlight. The **trail cameras** are mounted, their lenses trained on the tall grass, ready to capture any movement.

Makayla stands back, looking over their work, her face set with determination. **Mac** wipes his hands on his pants, stepping up beside her.

MAC

(quietly)
It's done.

MAKAYLA

(serious)
Now we wait.

Asher looks out toward the **tall grass**, his face tense, as though expecting to see something moving in the darkness.

Suddenly, a loud **crack of thunder** rolls across the sky, startling them all. The wind picks up again, stronger now, pulling at their clothes and causing the **grass** to sway wildly.

MAKAYLA

(focused)
Let's head inside. We'll check the cameras after the storm passes.

As they start to head back toward the house, **Mac** hesitates, glancing one last time at the **tall grass**. For a brief moment, he thinks he sees something--**glowing eyes**--watching from between the swaying blades. His heart skips a beat, but when he blinks, they're gone.

EXT. MAC'S HOUSE - NIGHT

They make their way to the **back door**, the wind now roaring in their ears. As they step onto the porch, **Dallas** watches them from the kitchen, his face shadowed by concern. He waves them inside, pulling the door open just as the first heavy drops of **rain** begin to fall.

INT. MAC'S HOUSE - KITCHEN - NIGHT

Inside, **Dallas** resumes washing the dirt off the **potatoes**, his movements slow and thoughtful. The sound of the storm outside begins to build, the wind rattling the windows and sending faint creaks through the old house.

The kids stand around the kitchen table, staring out the window toward the **backyard**, where their traps sit, waiting in the darkness.

ASHER

(uneasy, to himself)
I really hope we're ready for this.

MAKAYLA

(firmly)
We are.

They watch as the rain begins to pour down in sheets, the storm finally making its presence known. The tension in the room grows as they prepare for whatever is coming--whether it's just a hurricane or something far worse.

EXT. MAC'S HOUSE - NIGHT

The storm rages through the night, with the wind howling and rain lashing against the windows. The kids remain tense, gathered around the kitchen table, watching the backyard, waiting for any sign that their traps have been triggered.

The night stretches on, but nothing happens. No glowing eyes. No signs of movement from the tall grass.

INT. MAC'S HOUSE - MORNING

The sun peeks through the **blinds**, and the sound of **birds chirping** fills the air. The storm has passed, but not in the way anyone expected. **Mac, Makayla, and Asher** stir awake at the kitchen table, where they'd fallen asleep while keeping watch.

Dallas is already up, his hands working the coffee maker, the smell of fresh coffee wafting through the room.

DALLAS

(quietly, almost amused)
Looks like the storm wasn't as bad as they said.

Mac groggily rubs his eyes and stands up, stretching and looking out the window toward the **backyard**. The fishing wire and traps remain undisturbed. The tall grass sways lazily in the gentle morning breeze, the threat from the night before now feeling distant.

MAKAYLA

(slightly frustrated, rubbing her temples)
We stayed up all night... for nothing?

ASHER

(relieved, but still a little uneasy)
I'm okay with nothing.

DALLAS

(sipping his coffee)
 School's back in session. I heard the announcement on the radio. No hurricane, just some bad winds. You all better get ready.

Makayla frowns, clearly disappointed but determined to figure out why nothing happened. She grabs her backpack and heads for the door.

MAKAYLA

(to herself, firm)
 It's not over.

Mac watches her for a moment, then looks at **Asher**, who shrugs, still processing the anticlimactic end to the night. He grabs his own bag, and they all head for the door, leaving behind the strange traps in the backyard.

EXT. SCHOOL - DAY

The sun shines brightly, with a few leftover clouds drifting lazily through the sky. The school grounds are bustling with students, all of them chatting about the **false alarm** of the hurricane, relieved that it never hit.

Makayla, Mac, and Asher arrive at the school together, walking past groups of students who are laughing and recounting how they spent the night indoors, preparing for what ended up being nothing more than a strong windstorm.

STUDENT #1

(grinning)
 My dad boarded up the windows for nothing. Spent the whole night in the basement.

STUDENT #2

(laughing)
 Yeah, we even packed up the car, but the storm never came.

Makayla barely pays attention to the other kids, her mind still on the events of the night. She stops in front of the school, staring at the building like it's a problem she needs to solve.

MAC

(noticing her tension)
 You okay? I mean, it wasn't a total waste, right? We'll try again tonight.

MAKAYLA

(shaking her head)

No. We missed something. There's a pattern to all this. The storm, the creatures--it's all connected. We just didn't see it.

ASHER

(slightly exasperated)

Can't we just be happy nothing happened? Maybe it's over.

MAKAYLA

(quietly, determined)

It's not over. They're waiting for something. The storm was just a distraction.

INT. SCHOOL CLASSROOM - DAY

Inside the classroom, the **teacher** is writing the day's lesson on the chalkboard while the students settle in.

Makayla, Mac, and Asher sit together in the back of the room, their eyes drifting toward the window where the sky is now completely clear, almost mocking their efforts from the night before.

The lesson is mundane, going over basic science principles about **weather systems**, but Makayla is lost in her thoughts. She pulls out her **notebook** and starts sketching the **symbols** they saw near the burn marks again, circling them, drawing lines, trying to connect the dots. **Mac** watches her for a moment, then glances outside, unsure if their efforts mean anything anymore.

Suddenly, a piece of chalk snaps against the blackboard, and the **teacher** turns to the class.

TEACHER

(classroom voice)

Alright, everyone. Now that the storm has passed, we're going to continue our lessons on weather patterns. Last night was a prime example of how unpredictable systems can be. What did we learn about the **false alarm** and how storms can dissipate?

STUDENT #3

(raising their hand)

That sometimes the conditions change before the storm hits?

TEACHER

(nodding)

Exactly. You can never predict with complete accuracy. Weather has a way of shifting unexpectedly. But just because a storm didn't hit doesn't mean we shouldn't have been prepared.

As the **teacher** continues, Makayla stops drawing and stares hard at the chalkboard. Something clicks in her mind.

MAKAYLA

(whispering to Mac)

That's it. It wasn't the storm--it was the conditions around it. Something changed last night. That's why they didn't show up. We just need to figure out what.

MAC

(raising an eyebrow)

You think we missed something?

MAKAYLA

(nodding)

Yeah. And we're going to find out what it is. Tonight.

ASHER

(whispering, slumping in his seat)

Great. Another sleepless night...

EXT. SCHOOL - AFTERNOON

The school bell rings, and the kids flood out of the building. **Makayla, Mac, and Asher** walk away from the school, their determination reignited. The **bustling schoolyard** contrasts with the quiet unease still lingering between them.

MAKAYLA

(serious)

We set the traps again tonight. This time, we don't miss anything.

MAC

(supportive)

Alright. We're with you.

ASHER

(reluctant)

Yeah, yeah... But if nothing happens again, I'm sleeping through the next one.

They walk off, their minds racing with possibilities as the bright afternoon sun fades into a cloudy dusk, the looming sense of something unfinished hanging over them.

EXT. TOWN CENTER - DAY

The streets of the small coastal town are busy, but the atmosphere is tense. People hurry between shops, stocking up on supplies. **SAND BAGS** are piled up in front of storefronts, and **BOARDED WINDOWS** are everywhere. A few cars with **WEATHER SERVICE STICKERS** drive by with loudspeakers blaring:

WEATHER SERVICE

(through loudspeaker)

Attention, residents. A mandatory evacuation order is in place. Hurricane force winds are expected to reach landfall within the next 24 hours. Prepare for the worst.

INT. GROCERY STORE - SAME TIME

MAKAYLA, **MAC**, and **ASHER** move through the aisles of the packed grocery store. The store is chaotic, with people grabbing supplies off shelves in a panic. The kids pick up some water and snacks, but their focus is elsewhere.

ASHER

(looking around, nervously whispering)

Everyone's freaking out. My dad says the storm's moving faster than they thought.

MAC

(grabbing a bottle of water)

Do they even know what's causing it?

Makayla's eyes dart around, her mind racing.

MAKAYLA

They think it's just the storm. But we know it's more than that.

The kids reach the checkout line, where **OVERHEAD NEWS REPORTS** play on the TVs mounted in the store. A **NEWS ANCHOR** speaks urgently.

NEWS ANCHOR (V.O.)

Hurricane Wallace has intensified to a Category 4. Officials are warning residents to evacuate. Widespread damage is expected along the coast.

Makayla stares at the screen, the weight of the situation sinking in.

MAKAYLA

(to the others, quietly)

We're running out of time. We need to figure out what the creatures are trying to do--before the storm hits.

EXT. TOWN - LATER THAT DAY

The sky is darkening as the wind picks up. **TOWN WORKERS** are putting up **STORM SHUTTERS** on buildings, while others reinforce **TELEPHONE POLES**. The whole town feels like it's holding its breath.

MAKAYLA, **MAC**, and **ASHER** stand near the **TOWN HALL**, looking at the preparations. Makayla clutches her grandfather's journal, her face serious.

MAC

(worried)

What if we're wrong, Makayla? What if the storm hits before we figure it out?

MAKAYLA

(determined)

We're not wrong. My grandfather knew something. We have to reenact the ritual--it's the only way to communicate with the creatures.

ASHER

(skeptical)

And how do we even know it'll work? We've never done anything like this before.

Makayla flips through the journal, stopping on the page with the **RITUAL INSTRUCTIONS**. The drawings depict strange symbols, stones, and what looks like a **CIRCLE OF OBJECTS** arranged on the ground.

MAKAYLA

We need to gather these things. My grandfather wrote about symbolic objects from the town's history. Things that mean something to the creatures.

MAC

Like what?

MAKAYLA

(reading the journal)

Stuff like stones from the oldest parts of town, plants from the shoreline. He said the creatures respond to things tied to the land... to the history of the town. If we can gather them and set them up in the tall grass during the storm, maybe they'll listen. Maybe they'll stop the hurricane.

ASHER

(nervous)

And if they don't?

MAKAYLA

(determined)

We'll make them listen.

The wind blows harder, whipping through their hair as they exchange uneasy glances.

EXT. OLD TOWN SQUARE - EVENING

The kids move quickly through the **OLD TOWN SQUARE**, where the oldest buildings stand. They scour the area, looking for **OBJECTS** that could fit the descriptions in the journal. Makayla kneels down near a large, weathered **STONE** embedded in the ground near the old well.

MAKAYLA

(grabbing the stone)

This. This is one of them. It's been here since the town was founded. Grandpa wrote about it. The creatures will recognize it.

Mac helps her pull it free, and they stuff it into a **BACKPACK**. Asher, still limping slightly from his injury, keeps watch.

ASHER

(glancing around)

We need to hurry. The storm's picking up.

INT. MAKAYLA'S HOUSE - NIGHT

DALLAS sits at the kitchen table, staring out at the darkening sky. His face is lined with concern. Makayla enters, her backpack slung over her shoulder.

DALLAS

(serious)

The town's evacuating. We're supposed to leave in the morning.

MAKAYLA

(shaking her head)

We can't. Not yet.

Dallas looks at her, startled by her conviction.

DALLAS

What do you mean, "not yet"?

Makayla sits down across from him, placing her grandfather's journal on the table. She opens it to the page with the ritual.

MAKAYLA

Grandpa knew something. About the creatures... about the storm. If we reenact the ritual, we might be able to stop the hurricane.

Dallas stares at the journal, then at his daughter, his disbelief evident.

DALLAS

Makayla... this is dangerous. We don't even know if it's real. The storm's coming, and if we don't leave--

MAKAYLA

(cutting him off, her voice rising)

I know it's real. Grandpa saw them. And we've seen them too. If we don't do this, the whole town could be destroyed.

Dallas is silent, torn between his fear for his daughter and the growing realization that she might be right.

EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - NIGHT

The wind howls as the kids stand at the edge of the **TALL GRASS FIELD**, their backpacks loaded with symbolic items from the town's history. The sky is nearly black, and **LIGHTNING** flashes in the distance. The storm is almost here.

Makayla, gripping the journal, steps forward into the swaying grass.

MAKAYLA

This is it. We set the objects in a circle, just like Grandpa described.

MAC

(nervously)

Are we really going to do this during the hurricane?

MAKAYLA

We have no choice. If we don't, the hurricane will destroy everything. We have to make the creatures listen.

The kids begin to set up the **CIRCLE OF OBJECTS** as the wind intensifies. The storm is on the horizon, and the sky rumbles with thunder.

Makayla looks up, scanning the distance for any sign of the **CREATURES**. Her face is set with determination, but there's a flicker of fear in her eyes.

MAKAYLA

(quietly)

We're almost out of time.

EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - NIGHT

The wind howls through the tall grass as **MAKAYLA**, **MAC**, and **ASHER** (on **SPEAKERPHONE**) prepare for their most daring mission yet. The sky above is dark, with **THUNDER** rumbling ominously in the distance. Their **CAMERAS** and **EQUIPMENT** are set up on the ground, barely holding steady as the wind picks up.

MAKAYLA

(raising her voice over the wind)

Okay, cameras are ready. We just need to be patient. They'll come.

Mac fidgets nervously, glancing at the swaying grass around them. The tension is palpable, the air thick with anticipation.

MAC

(uncertain)

And what if they don't? What if this doesn't work?

ASHER (V.O.)

(through the speakerphone, from his hospital bed)

They'll come. They always do when the storm gets close. Just keep the cameras steady.

As the kids finish setting up, **GLIMPSES OF LIGHT** flicker in the distance, faint but unmistakable. **GLOWING EYES** emerge from the dark patches of the field, moving toward them slowly, like they're watching, observing.

MAKAYLA

(eyes wide)

There... do you see them?

MAC

(nodding, voice shaking)

Yeah... I see them.

They stand frozen, staring at the **ETHEREAL FORMS** that drift through the grass, barely visible but real. The creatures' movements are slow, graceful, their **GLOWING EYES** locked onto the kids.

Suddenly, one of the creatures **STEPS FORWARD**, its eyes glowing brighter than the others. The cameras are recording everything, the footage shaky but capturing the surreal moment.

MAKAYLA

(whispers, barely audible)
It's them...

The creature seems to grow larger as it approaches, its form becoming more defined. It looks almost human, but its body is made of light and mist, shifting with the wind.

MAC

(terrified, backing up slightly)
Makayla... we should go...

MAKAYLA

(steady, holding her ground)
No. Stay. We need to know.

The creature **LIFTS ITS ARM**, and suddenly, the world around the kids seems to warp. The wind dies down momentarily, and a vision appears in the sky above them--a **VISION OF THE HURRICANE**, raging violently over their town. **BUILDINGS COLLAPSE, TREES UPROOT**, and the **COASTLINE FLOODS** with water.

MAC

(watching in horror)
What... what is this?

MAKAYLA

(in awe)
It's showing us... what's going to happen.

The vision shifts again, this time to a **DIFFERENT TIME**--the town from decades ago, peaceful and serene. The creatures are there, **LIVING ALONGSIDE THE TOWNSPEOPLE**. They move through the fields, not as threats, but as protectors.

MAKAYLA

(realizing, her voice soft)
They're not here to hurt us... they've been here all along. They're part of the town.

The vision begins to **FADE**, the storm and the past blending together. The creatures' **GLOWING EYES** return to focus, and for a moment, they just stand there, watching Makayla and Mac, as if waiting for something.

MAC

(breathless, shaken)
They're trying to tell us something. They're warning us.

MAKAYLA

(determined)

They're warning us to fix it. The storm... it's coming because something's wrong. We need to balance things again.

The **CREATURES** slowly **RETREAT INTO THE GRASS**, their forms dissipating like mist in the wind. The moment is over, but the weight of what they've seen lingers.

INT. HOSPITAL ROOM - LATER THAT NIGHT

ASHER lies in his hospital bed, his **LAPTOP** in front of him. He's on a **VIDEO CALL** with Makayla and Mac, who are still reeling from the encounter.

MAKAYLA (V.O.)

(on the video call)

We saw them. And they showed us... everything. The hurricane, the past. They've always been here.

Asher nods, but he's more focused on the footage on his laptop screen. He rewinds and pauses on a frame, revealing a **CLEAR IMAGE OF THE CREATURE**. It's more defined than anything they've captured before--its **GLOWING EYES** sharp and its form almost humanoid.

ASHER

(excited)

I've been going through the footage... look at this. It's clearer than anything we've seen before.

Makayla and Mac lean in closer to their screen, watching the creature on Asher's laptop. They've never seen it this clearly before--there's something almost **HUMAN** in its features, despite its otherworldly appearance.

MAC

(stunned)

That's... incredible.

ASHER

And there's more. I talked to my dad--he works at the weather station. He says the hurricane is going to hit tomorrow night, right after the Harvest Festival. If we don't do something by then... it'll be too late.

MAKAYLA

(resolute)

Then we need to reenact the ritual. Tomorrow night, during the storm. That's when we'll have the best chance of reaching them.

EXT. HOSPITAL PARKING LOT - LATE NIGHT

Makayla and Mac walk away from the hospital, the wind picking up again as the storm continues to grow closer. The air feels thick with tension, but their purpose is clear now.

MAC

(nervous)

Do you really think we can stop this? That the ritual will work?

MAKAYLA

(serious)

We don't have a choice. The creatures showed us what'll happen if we don't. They're giving us a chance to fix this.

The sky above them rumbles with distant thunder, and the first drops of rain begin to fall. The hurricane is on the horizon, and they know they're running out of time.

INT. MAKAYLA'S LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Makayla sits alone at the kitchen table, the journal spread out in front of her. **DALLAS** stands at the window, watching the storm clouds gather. He knows something is wrong but can't fully understand what Makayla has been through.

DALLAS

(softly, without turning around)

The storm's getting worse.

Makayla looks up, her mind racing with the visions the creatures showed her. She knows they don't have long.

MAKAYLA

(whispers)

We have one more chance.

ACT 3: CONFRONTATION WITH THE CREATURES**EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - NIGHT**

The **TALL GRASS** rustles violently under the weight of the storm brewing overhead. **MAKAYLA** and **MAC** crouch low, setting up **CAMERAS** and instruments.

Their flashlights cut through the dark, but the tension in the air is thicker than the wind swirling around them. The storm is near, but the kids are even closer to the creatures.

MAKAYLA

(whispering)

We have to get the footage this time.

MAC

(nervously adjusting the camera)

Are you sure they're going to show up?

Makayla's eyes dart around the field, focusing on the swaying grass. She's determined, but there's a flicker of doubt in her voice.

MAKAYLA

They'll come. We're right where Grandpa said they'd be.

The **WIND PICKS UP** as they settle into position, hiding behind the equipment. Lightning flashes in the distance, briefly illuminating the vast field. For a moment, everything is silent.

Then--glowing eyes.

In the distance, **GLOWING FIGURES** begin to emerge from the tall grass, moving toward them. **ETHEREAL FORMS**, both human-like and otherworldly, drift through the grass. Their movements are fluid, almost as if they're part of the wind itself.

MAC

(his voice trembling)

Oh my god... they're real.

The kids freeze as the creatures grow closer, their eyes glowing brighter with each step. The creatures aren't just watching--they're coming directly for them.

EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - CONTINUOUS

The cameras are rolling. Makayla holds her breath as the creatures **STOP**, just feet away from them. Their forms are **CLEARER THAN EVER**, shimmering in the moonlight, their eyes glowing with an intensity that seems to pierce the night.

CREATURE LEADER

(without words, through presence)

You must understand.

Suddenly, the world around them **FADES**. Makayla and Mac are no longer standing in the tall grass--they're surrounded by swirling images. **VISIONS OF THE FUTURE**.

VISION:

INTENSE HURRICANE WINDS tear through their town. **BUILDINGS CRUMBLE**, trees are uprooted, and the coastline is swallowed by floodwaters. The destruction is total.

MAKAYLA

(panicked)
No...

But the vision **SHIFTS**. Now, they're standing in the same field, but it's **YEARS AGO**. The town is peaceful, and the creatures move freely among the people, their presence accepted. They're **PROTECTORS**, maintaining balance.

CREATURE LEADER (V.O.)

(through the vision)
We lived among you. But the balance is broken.

The vision shifts again--back to the storm, the destruction more vivid than before. The creatures are showing them the **RESULT OF THE BROKEN BALANCE**.

EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - BACK TO PRESENT

The vision fades, and Makayla and Mac are left gasping, the weight of the revelation hitting them like a physical blow. The creatures' **GLOWING EYES** remain fixed on them, but the message is clear: they must fix the balance or the town will be destroyed.

MAC

(stunned)
The storm... it's because of the balance.

Makayla's mind races, but her resolve hardens. She knows what they have to do now.

MAKAYLA

(firm)
We have to reenact the ritual. It's the only way to stop this.

The creatures' forms begin to **DISSIPATE**, their glowing eyes the last to disappear into the wind, leaving Makayla and Mac alone in the storm.

The cameras are still recording, but the gravity of what they've seen is far more powerful than any footage.

INT. HOSPITAL ROOM - NIGHT

ASHER sits in his hospital bed, his **LAPTOP** open in front of him. The video feed from Makayla and Mac's cameras plays on the screen, capturing the creatures in more detail than ever before. His eyes widen in shock.

He **PICKS UP HIS PHONE** and dials quickly.

ASHER

(urgent, into the phone)

Guys, I'm watching the footage. You were right--they're trying to warn us. We have to move fast.

INTERCUT WITH:

INT. MAKAYLA'S HOUSE - CONTINUOUS

Makayla and Mac are back in **MAKAYLA'S LIVING ROOM**, huddled around the journal, the wind still howling outside. **DALLAS** stands nearby, visibly concerned.

MAKAYLA

(on the phone with Asher)

What did you find?

ASHER (V.O.)

(from the hospital)

I talked to my dad--he says the hurricane's going to make landfall tomorrow night, right after the Harvest Festival. If we don't stop it by then...

MAKAYLA

(interrupting)

We know. The creatures showed us what's going to happen.

Asher pulls up more footage on his laptop--an older recording from one of their previous encounters with the creatures. But this time, he zooms in on something they hadn't noticed before: **ANCIENT SYMBOLS** glowing faintly in the background.

ASHER (V.O.)

Look at this. I found something in the footage. Symbols... from the journal. It's connected to the ritual.

Makayla flips through the journal frantically, finding the corresponding symbols. Her eyes light up with realization.

MAKAYLA

(to Mac and Dallas)

These symbols... they're part of the ritual. We need to recreate this exact pattern in the tall grass. It's the only way to communicate with them fully. If we don't, the hurricane will destroy everything.

MAC

(nervous but determined)

Then we better hurry.

INT. HOSPITAL ROOM - CONTINUOUS

Asher watches the footage one last time, his heart racing. He knows what they need to do, but the clock is ticking. The storm outside the hospital window is already starting to intensify.

ASHER

(into the phone)

You guys do the ritual... I'll keep tracking the storm from here. My dad's got access to the radar--we'll know exactly when it's going to hit.

EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - NIGHT

Makayla, Mac, and Dallas stand at the edge of the tall grass, the journal clutched in Makayla's hands. The **SYMBOLS** from the journal are now drawn out in the dirt, illuminated by their flashlights. The wind is ferocious, the storm growing stronger by the minute.

MAKAYLA

(steely determination)

This is it. We do it now, or it's over.

Dallas looks at his daughter, concern etched on his face, but he nods. He knows there's no turning back.

DALLAS

(serious)

Let's finish this.

The three of them move into the tall grass, the **THUNDER** booming overhead as they prepare to perform the **RITUAL** that will determine the fate of the town.

ACT 3: THE FINAL PLAN**EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - NIGHT**

The wind whips violently across the field, the storm growing closer. **MAKAYLA**, **MAC**, and **DALLAS** stand together, staring at the intricate **SYMBOLS** they've carved into the dirt, surrounded by **STONES** and **PLANTS** gathered from the town. The ritual is set, but the tension is palpable.

Dallas watches the storm on the horizon, his face tight with worry. He's in it now--no turning back. He grips a tool belt at his side, filled with the equipment they'll need to complete the ritual.

DALLAS

(uneasy, to Makayla)

You're sure this is going to work?

Makayla's eyes are determined, but there's a vulnerability behind them. She glances at her grandfather's **JOURNAL**, open in her hands, and takes a deep breath.

MAKAYLA

(softly)

I have to believe it will. Grandpa knew something. He left this for us... for me.

She looks up at Dallas, her voice quiet but filled with meaning.

MAKAYLA

I can't let him down.

INT. MAKAYLA'S HOUSE - FLASHBACK - EARLIER THAT DAY

DALLAS sits at the kitchen table, staring at a framed **PHOTO OF HIS WIFE**. The storm rattles the windows, but his gaze is far off, lost in memories.

FLASHBACK TO:**EXT. PARK - DAY**

DALLAS is holding hands with **MAC**'s mother, laughing as **YOUNG MAC** plays in the background. The sun is shining, everything peaceful, their family whole.

BACK TO PRESENT:

INT. MAKAYLA'S HOUSE - KITCHEN - DAY

Dallas blinks back to the present, the memory still heavy on his heart. He turns the photo face-down, his expression hardening.

DALLAS

(whispers, to himself)
I won't lose him too.

EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - NIGHT - BACK TO PRESENT

Dallas kneels by the ritual circle, the weight of the storm and his memories pressing down on him. He glances at **MAC**, who's setting up the final pieces. There's a quiet intensity in the air.

DALLAS

(to Mac, softer now)
You doing okay?

Mac looks up, surprised by the softness in his father's voice. There's a brief moment of understanding between them.

MAC

Yeah... I think so.

DALLAS

(nodding, struggling to find the words)
You remind me of your mom, you know. Strong. Determined.

The wind howls louder, but the quiet between them is filled with meaning.

MAC

(quietly, looking away)
I miss her too, Dad.

Dallas hesitates, the vulnerability catching him off-guard. He places a hand on Mac's shoulder, squeezing it gently.

DALLAS

We're going to get through this. Together.

Mac nods, the bond between them solidifying in the face of the storm.

EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - LATER THAT NIGHT

Makayla steps forward, her grandfather's journal still clutched in her hands. The **SYMBOLS** are glowing faintly now, reacting to the growing storm. **THUNDER ROLLS** in the distance, but her focus is on the ritual.

MAKAYLA

(to Dallas and Mac)

It's time. We have everything we need.

They gather around the circle, the wind nearly knocking them over as they begin placing the **OBJECTS** in the order described in the journal. Makayla kneels in the center of the circle, her eyes on the **GLOWING SYMBOLS** beneath her feet.

DALLAS

(yelling over the wind)

What now?

Makayla takes a deep breath, her voice steady despite the chaos around her.

MAKAYLA

We start the chant. Just like Grandpa wrote.

She opens the journal, her hands shaking slightly as she begins to **RECITE THE RITUAL**. Her voice is low at first, but as the words spill out, the wind seems to respond. The grass around them starts to swirl, and the symbols glow brighter.

Dallas watches his daughter, pride and fear warring on his face. He steps closer to her, placing his hand on her shoulder as she continues the chant.

MAKAYLA

(her voice breaking, but strong)

Grandpa... help me.

The **CREATURES' EYES** begin to glow in the distance, their presence felt but not yet seen.

EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - CONTINUOUS

The ritual grows in intensity as Makayla's chant echoes through the storm. The **GROUND SHAKES**, and the **GLOWING EYES** of the creatures come closer, their ethereal forms moving through the grass toward the circle.

MAKAYLA

(her voice filled with determination)

We're here to make things right. Please... help us.

Suddenly, the creatures' eyes glow even brighter, and the wind whips the grass into a frenzy. The storm is on the edge of exploding, but the **CREATURES** seem to hesitate.

DALLAS

(desperate)

Is it working?

Before Makayla can respond, the **CREATURE LEADER** steps forward from the tall grass, its form more defined than ever. Its **GLOWING EYES** lock onto Makayla, Mac, and Dallas.

The creature **LIFTS ITS ARM**, and the **WIND SLOWS**, as if waiting for the ritual to finish.

MAKAYLA

(breathless, her voice barely audible)

Grandpa... guide me.

INT. MAKAYLA'S LIVING ROOM - FLASHBACK - NIGHT

Makayla, much younger, sits on her grandfather's lap as he tells her stories about the creatures in the tall grass.

GRANDFATHER

(softly)

They're not here to hurt us, Makayla. They're here to protect us. But only if we protect them too.

EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - BACK TO PRESENT

Makayla's voice rises above the wind.

MAKAYLA

(pleading)

We're trying to protect the balance... just like Grandpa did.

The **CREATURE LEADER** pauses, its form glowing even brighter. There's a moment of eerie calm, the storm hanging on the edge of chaos.

Dallas steps closer to Makayla, his voice filled with emotion.

DALLAS

(softly)

You're doing this, Makayla. Your grandfather would be proud.

Makayla nods, her eyes welling with tears, but her focus is unwavering.

EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - CONTINUOUS

The **CREATURE LEADER** finally lowers its arm, and the **WIND** picks up again. The other creatures begin to **MOVE IN CLOSER**, their forms circling the ritual site.

MAKAYLA

(voice steady)

Please... help us restore the balance.

The creatures pause for a moment longer, their glowing eyes reflecting in the stormy night. Then, one by one, they begin to **GLOW BRIGHTER**, as if acknowledging the ritual.

INT. HOSPITAL ROOM - SAME TIME

ASHER watches the storm through his hospital window, his laptop open with the **STORM TRACKER** on screen. His heart pounds as he watches the radar.

ASHER

(to himself)

Come on, guys. You've got this.

He pulls out his phone and texts Makayla.

TEXT FROM ASHER:

"The storm's about to hit. You're almost out of time."

EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - CONTINUOUS

Makayla glances at her phone, her heart racing. The storm is almost here, but the creatures seem to be responding. The **SYMBOLS** in the dirt glow even brighter now, the storm swirling above them.

DALLAS

(urgently)

We have to finish this before the storm hits!

Makayla nods, her voice filled with determination.

MAKAYLA

(louder, to the creatures)

Help us restore the balance. Protect the town.

The creatures seem to understand. The **WIND SLOWS** even further, and the **CREATURE LEADER** steps forward, raising its arm once more.

In that moment, the storm **PAUSES**, the creatures' eyes glowing like stars in the night.

MAKAYLA

(whispering)

It's working...

ACT 3: THE STORM HITS DURING THE HARVEST FESTIVAL

EXT. TOWN SQUARE - HARVEST FESTIVAL - NIGHT

The **HARVEST FESTIVAL** is in full swing. Bright lights illuminate the booths and rides, but the atmosphere is tense. **VENDORS** and **TOWNSPEOPLE** move quickly, glancing up at the darkening sky. The storm is approaching--**THUNDER RUMBLES** in the distance, and the wind picks up speed.

Makayla, Mac, and Dallas are at the edge of the festival, eyes on the gathering clouds.

MAKAYLA

(quietly to Mac)

We have to go now. It's getting worse.

Mac nods, glancing at Dallas. There's an unspoken understanding between them.

DALLAS

(to the kids)

Go. I'll stay close by. If anything happens...

Makayla nods and grabs her **BACKPACK**, filled with the objects for the ritual. She and Mac slip away from the crowd, moving toward the tall grass, disappearing into the night. Dallas watches them go, his face tight with concern. The **CARNIVAL MUSIC** and **SHOUTS** from the festival fade into the background as he follows them at a distance.

EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - NIGHT

The wind is howling now, the grass whipping violently in the storm. **LIGHTNING FLASHES** across the sky as Makayla and Mac reach the ritual site.

The symbols they carved into the dirt earlier are still glowing faintly, flickering in and out as the storm intensifies.

MAKAYLA

(urgently)

We don't have much time.

They set down the **STONES** and **OFFERINGS**--each one tied to the town's past, items passed down through generations. Makayla places her **GRANDFATHER'S COMPASS** in the center of the circle, her hands trembling slightly.

MAC

(nervously looking at the sky)

What if this doesn't work?

Makayla glances at him, her resolve hardening.

MAKAYLA

It has to.

They begin the **CHANT**, their voices barely audible over the wind. The storm grows fiercer, **RAIN** starting to pour down in sheets.

EXT. TOWN SQUARE - CONTINUOUS

Back at the festival, the townspeople are starting to panic. **TENTS** are being ripped from their anchors, and the **WIND** sends debris flying. The **WEATHER SERVICE** van drives by, blaring evacuation orders.

WEATHER SERVICE

(through loudspeakers)

This is a mandatory evacuation! Leave the area immediately!

Dallas stands on the edge of the festival, his eyes fixed on the tall grass where the kids disappeared. He knows he should evacuate with the others, but something holds him back.

EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - CONTINUOUS

As the kids continue the chant, the **GLOWING EYES** of the creatures begin to appear in the darkness once again. But this time, the creatures are larger, more defined, their forms towering over the field. Their **MENACING FIGURES** move through the storm, their presence amplified by the raging wind and lightning.

MAKAYLA

(whispers, barely audible)
They're here.

The creatures step closer, their **EYES BURNING BRIGHTLY**, and Makayla feels a surge of fear--but she doesn't stop chanting. The symbols in the dirt glow even brighter, and the wind seems to center around them.

EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - CONTINUOUS

Dallas watches from a distance, the rain soaking him to the bone. His heart races as the creatures become visible, their forms barely human but unmistakably real. He's terrified for the kids but stays rooted to the spot, unable to look away.

As the ritual reaches its peak, the **CREATURE LEADER** steps forward, its eyes locking onto Dallas. Suddenly, Dallas feels a shift--a strange calm washes over him, and he's transported into a **VISION**.

VISION:**EXT. PARK - DAY (DALLAS'S MEMORY)**

Dallas stands in a familiar park. It's sunny and warm, the wind gentle. **MAC'S MOTHER**, Dallas's wife, stands in front of him, smiling--just as she did the last time they were here. Her laughter echoes in the air, and for a moment, everything feels peaceful again.

DALLAS

(whispers, tears welling up)
I miss you.

She steps forward, placing her hand on his cheek. Her touch feels real, warm.

DALLAS'S WIFE

(softly)
Take care of him, Dallas. You'll be okay.

Before he can respond, the vision starts to fade. The storm's sound begins to seep back in, and his wife's figure starts to dissolve into the wind.

EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - BACK TO PRESENT

Dallas is back in the field, but something has changed in him. His face is wet with rain--and with tears. The creatures are still watching, but their presence feels different now. Less threatening.

DALLAS

(softly, to the creatures)
I understand.

EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - CONTINUOUS

Makayla's voice breaks slightly as she continues the chant. The creatures are closer now, almost surrounding them. Suddenly, she feels a strange pull in her chest, and everything around her **STOPS**. The wind, the rain--everything goes still.

GRANDFATHER (V.O.)

(softly)
Makayla.

She gasps, recognizing the voice immediately. She looks around, and there, standing at the edge of the circle, is her **GRANDFATHER**, his form faint but unmistakable. Tears fill her eyes as she stares at him.

MAKAYLA

(voice trembling)
Grandpa...?

He steps forward, his eyes gentle but filled with urgency.

GRANDFATHER

The balance, Makayla. You have to finish it.

Makayla swallows hard, nodding. She feels the weight of her responsibility, but also the love and support of her grandfather, as if he's guiding her through the ritual.

EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - CONTINUOUS

The storm resumes in full force, the creatures' glowing eyes watching as Makayla takes a deep breath and continues the chant, her voice stronger now.

MAKAYLA

(chanting louder)
We restore the balance. We protect the land.

The **CREATURE LEADER** steps forward once more, raising its arm toward the sky. The storm around them seems to respond--the wind shifts, and the rain lessens.

Dallas, still watching, feels a sense of calm wash over him again. The visions, the creatures, the storm--it's all connected, tied to the town and its history.

EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - CONTINUOUS

As Makayla finishes the final words of the chant, the creatures seem to glow brighter, their forms shimmering in the stormy night. Then, one by one, they start to **DISSIPATE**, fading into the wind, leaving behind only the faintest trace of their presence.

The storm begins to **SUBSIDE**, the wind slowing to a gentle breeze. The rain lightens, and the sky, once filled with dark clouds, starts to **CLEAR**.

Makayla, Mac, and Dallas stand in the **TALL GRASS**, breathing heavily, their faces a mix of relief and awe. They did it. The ritual worked.

EXT. TOWN SQUARE - LATER

The **HARVEST FESTIVAL** has been abandoned, the rides and booths standing eerily still in the aftermath of the storm. But the town is safe. The hurricane has passed.

Dallas and the kids walk back into the town, drenched and exhausted, but there's a sense of peace in the air. The storm may be over, but they all know that the creatures will always be watching, maintaining the balance.

MAKAYLA

(softly, to herself)
We did it, Grandpa.

She glances up at the sky, and for just a moment, she swears she sees her grandfather's face in the clouds, smiling down at her.

ACT 3: THE CREATURE SAVES THE TOWN**EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - NIGHT**

The **WIND** is still swirling around the kids and **DALLAS**, but it's starting to shift, slowing down as the ritual nears completion. **MAKAYLA** stands at the center of the circle, the **SYMBOLS** glowing brightly beneath her feet. **MAC** and **DALLAS** look on, both exhausted and amazed.

The **CREATURES** that surrounded them are beginning to react. Their **GLOWING EYES** intensify as they step forward, their forms towering above the field. But now, there's no menace in their presence--only a quiet power.

MAKAYLA

(chanting, voice rising)

Restore the balance. Protect the land.

CREATURE LEADER

(without words, through presence)

We hear you.

Suddenly, the **CREATURES** lift their arms as one, and a surge of energy bursts forth from them. The air around them **SHIMMERS**, and the ground beneath them vibrates. **LIGHTNING** crackles across the sky, but instead of destruction, it feels like the energy is healing the land.

EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - CONTINUOUS

As the creatures release the energy, the storm begins to **CALM**. The **WIND** dies down, the **RAIN** becomes a gentle drizzle, and the **THUNDER** quiets in the distance. The **SKY**, once dark and menacing, begins to **CLEAR**. Faint stars peek through the clouds.

MAC

(whispering, in awe)

It's working.

Makayla lowers her arms, her face lit by the faint glow of the symbols. The **CREATURES** slowly begin to **FADE**, their forms dissolving into the mist. One by one, they **DISAPPEAR** into the tall grass, leaving behind only their **GLOWING EYES**, watching over the field.

EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - LATER

The storm has passed. **MAKAYLA**, **MAC**, and **DALLAS** stand together, drenched and exhausted, but there's a sense of peace in the air. The town has been saved, and they've restored the balance.

The **GLOWING EYES** of the creatures linger in the distance for a moment longer, a quiet acknowledgment of their work. Then, finally, they too disappear, leaving the field quiet and still.

Makayla wipes rain from her face, her eyes distant as she looks out at the empty field. Dallas steps up beside her, placing a hand on her shoulder. There's a heaviness in his eyes, but also relief.

DALLAS

(softly)

You did it, Makayla.

Makayla turns to look at him, her face filled with quiet pride and emotion.

MAKAYLA

(quietly)

We all did.

She glances up at the sky, where the last remnants of the storm clouds are clearing, revealing the stars. For a brief moment, she swears she sees her **GRANDFATHER'S FACE**, smiling down at her, but it quickly fades into the night.

EXT. HARVEST FESTIVAL - NIGHT

Back in the **TOWN SQUARE**, the **HARVEST FESTIVAL** continues in the aftermath of the storm. People are slowly returning to the festival grounds, helping to pick up debris and reset the booths. There's a sense of quiet celebration now--the town is safe, and life goes on.

MAKAYLA, **MAC**, and **DALLAS** walk back into the square, their clothes still soaked but their faces filled with relief. They're greeted with curious glances from the townspeople, who have no idea what just happened, but for the kids, everything feels different.

MAKAYLA

(looking around, softly)

It feels like... something's changed.

Mac nods, looking at the familiar sights of the festival--the booths, the games, the families laughing in the distance.

MAC

(quietly)

We know something they don't.

Dallas stands beside them, his gaze distant as he watches the people celebrate. His mind drifts back to the **VISION OF HIS WIFE** from the ritual. The emotion of the moment washes over him, and he blinks back tears.

DALLAS

(softly, almost to himself)

I think they're watching over us now.

Makayla looks up at him, sensing the deeper meaning behind his words. She doesn't say anything, but she gives him a small, understanding nod.

EXT. TOWN SQUARE - LATER

The town has resumed its **FESTIVAL SPIRIT**. The lights are back on, the music is playing again, and the people are laughing and celebrating like nothing ever happened. But for Makayla, Mac, and Dallas, the night holds a deeper significance.

The kids stand on the edge of the square, watching the festivities with quiet smiles.

MAKAYLA

(to Mac, softly)

We did something important tonight.

Mac nods, glancing at her with a newfound respect.

MAC

(quietly)

We saved the town. Just like your grandpa would've done.

Makayla's face softens at the mention of her grandfather. She reaches into her pocket and pulls out his **COMPASS**, running her fingers over the familiar object.

MAKAYLA

(whispers, smiling)

Yeah. Just like he would've done.

She looks up at the sky one last time, her heart filled with peace. The stars twinkle above, and the storm is nothing but a memory now.

EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - NIGHT

Back in the **TALL GRASS FIELD**, the night is still and peaceful. The grass sways gently in the breeze, and the creatures are gone. But their presence lingers, a quiet reminder of the balance they've restored.

As the camera **PANS OUT** over the field, there's a faint glimmer in the distance--the faintest glow of **EYES** watching over the town, ensuring that the balance remains intact.

ACT 3: AMBIGUOUS ENDING**EXT. TOWN SQUARE - NIGHT**

The **HARVEST FESTIVAL** is winding down. The lights are dimming, the booths are closing, and the music has faded into the night. Families are packing up, and the once-lively square now holds a quieter energy. The storm is long gone, but the sense of relief lingers in the air.

MAKAYLA, **MAC**, and **DALLAS** stand together on the outskirts of the festival, their eyes fixed on the distant **TALL GRASS FIELD**. The field is dark and silent, but there's something about it--an unspoken presence that hasn't fully disappeared.

MAC

(softly, glancing at the field)
Do you think they're still out there?

Makayla watches the grass sway gently in the breeze, her mind still processing everything they've just been through. There's a faint glow of stars overhead, but the field remains a shadowy mystery.

MAKAYLA

(after a beat)
I don't know. Maybe.

DALLAS

(quietly, looking out into the distance)
I think they are. They'll always be watching.

There's a quiet understanding between them. The creatures, though unseen now, feel like they're still there--somehow connected to the land, to the town. The balance may have been restored, but the mystery remains unsolved.

EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - NIGHT

The camera slowly **PANS OUT** over the **TALL GRASS FIELD**, the wind gently rustling the grass. The field is empty, quiet, but there's a lingering sense of presence. The creatures may be gone, but their mark remains on the land.

As the camera pans further out, there's a faint **FLASH OF LIGHT**--barely visible--deep within the grass. **GLOWING EYES** flicker for just a moment, watching over the town before they **DISAPPEAR** once more into the shadows.

EXT. TOWN SQUARE - CONTINUOUS

Back at the town square, Makayla, Mac, and Dallas exchange a final glance. There's a sense of peace in the air, but they know the balance must always be maintained.

MAKAYLA

(quietly, to herself)
We have to protect it.

Mac looks at her, nodding in agreement.

MAC

Yeah... we do.

They turn back toward the festival, the last remnants of the celebration fading into the night. As they walk away, the camera lingers on the dark horizon--where the **TALL GRASS FIELD** meets the sky.

EXT. TALL GRASS FIELD - NIGHT

The field is still. The creatures are gone, for now. But the **AMBIENCE** of the night, the shadows in the tall grass, suggest that they're always there--watching, waiting, protecting. The mystery is far from solved, and the balance must always be kept.

FADE OUT.

THE END.